

Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed and accepted the revised Conference Evaluation Form which is in this year's Conference Manual.
- The committee discussed a proposal to plan Conference agendas two years in advance and decided not to accept the suggestion.
- The committee asked the staff to prepare a form for the committee to send out each September 1st to all Conference members to gather suggestions for Conference themes, presentations and workshop topics.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference ask their chairperson to confer with the Conference Agenda Committee chairperson and the staff member in connection with each quarterly board meeting.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee encourages the trustees' committee efforts to combine the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional," "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" and "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" with consideration to the following:

- 1) Brief introduction for professional groups and individuals who have contact with alcoholics.
- 2) Consider a professional presentation of items found in the A.A. Fact Sheet to provide a simple and concise overview of Alcoholics Anonymous and how we can be helpful as a resource for professionals.

- 3) Incorporate the theme "A.A. as a Resource" so it can be used in a variety of presentations. (Professionals, Community Agencies, employee Assistance Programs, etc.)

- 4) The C.P.C. Conference Committee maintains that this will eliminate the duplication and redundancy that currently exists in the above mentioned pamphlets.

- The committee suggested the following changes be made to the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous":

- 1) Retitle the section "The Nonalcoholic Addict" on page 2 to "Singleness of Purpose and

Problems Other Than Alcohol," and replace the first paragraph with the following text:

"Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and non-alcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem."

- 2) In Item 14 under "What A.A. does not do" add (following "court officials") the words "social agencies, employers, etc."

- 3) Revise existing "treatment facility" titles to "facilities and institutions."

- The committee suggested that the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be added to the list of A.A. Conference-approved literature in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and found the contents to be sufficient.
- The committee discussed ways to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community by encouraging A.A. members to become active on C.P.C. committees and in sponsorship of professionals.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee continue its discussion on the use of the A.A. Web Site as a C.P.C. tool.

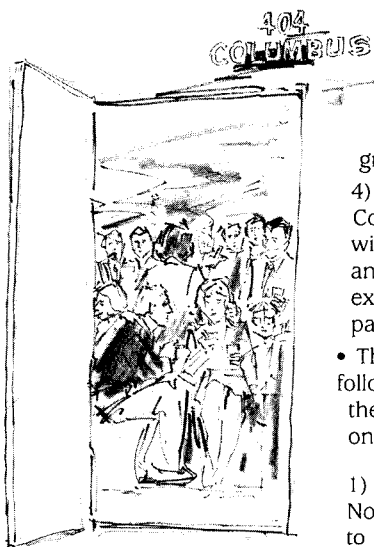
CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the proposed additions to the Correctional Facilities Workbook on youth detention centers and short-term facilities and referred them back, with suggestions, to the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities to be further developed and brought back for consideration by the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.
- The committee reviewed the Correctional Facilities Workbook and suggested adding the pamphlet, "Twelve Steps Illustrated," to the Correctional Facilities Workbook's Literature Guide under "For Inmates (easy-to-read)" and "For Professional Staff," at the next printing.
- The committee discussed adding A.A. groups that meet in correctional facilities to the mailing list of the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, and concluded that distribution of this newsletter to correctional facilities groups was a matter of area autonomy.
- The committee reviewed the remaining suggestions forwarded from the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and suggested the following:

- 1) The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities undertake a review of the current A.A. correctional facilities literature, and that Correctional Facilities chairs be asked the following questions:

- a) Is the present A.A. corrections literature meeting the service needs of the Fellowship?
- b) What A.A. literature is reaching correctional professionals and their facilities and treatment programs?
- c) Is there a demonstrated need for any additional corrections literature?

This report is to be brought back to the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for review.



- 2) An informational letter from the General Service Office to wardens be developed and brought back to the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities, along with projected costs of production and mailing.
- The committee reviewed the additional suggestions of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, and concluded that these suggestions did not fall within the scope of the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the current Self-Support pamphlet and suggested that the Publications Department review the page numbering of the current pamphlet since the numbering for the first few pages are inconsistent in pamphlets sampled.
- The committee discussed the Birthday Envelope Plan and considered the following ways of raising the Fellowship's consciousness: Communicate Birthday Envelope Plan information to delegates at the General Service Conference; give each delegate Birthday envelopes to distribute in their areas; include information about the Birthday Envelope Plan along with several contribution envelopes in New Group Handbooks, and in quarterly contribution letters.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed several suggestions for related items for production in 1999 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board for development two sets of tapes on the topics of: a) Carrying the Message; and b) Emotional Sobriety.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee reviewed a draft of a Composition, Scope and Procedure for this secondary committee and accepted it unanimously with minor revisions.
- It was suggested that consideration be given to including the delegate chairperson of this committee or a member of the committee in future site-selection trips.

LITERATURE

- The committee considered the request to remove the word "never" from page 14, line 14, of the section, "What does a sponsor do?" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and saw no need for change.
- The committee reviewed the background material on confidentiality and suggested that the material not be produced.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered a request to change the cutoff date for submitting Conference agenda items and determined that no change was necessary.
- The committee discussed additional background material on Conference agenda items and emphasized the importance of sending requested background material by February 15th of each year.
- The committee discussed the policy and role of observers at the General Service Conference, who are welcome and encouraged to observe, subject to the approval of the General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the responses regarding the forming of a Conference Archives Committee and felt there was no need.
- The Policy/Admissions Committee reviewed and discussed the scope of the Conference Committees and encouraged each Conference Committee to inventory itself.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee requested that the trustees' P.I. Committee report back to the 1998 Conference P.I. Committee on their study of updating, where necessary, all television and radio P.S.A.s including cultural references, availability in French and Spanish as well as formats compatible with current technology.
- The committee agreed to add "electronic media" to Section 1. of the current Scope of this committee as follows:
 - "1) Create greater understanding of the Fellowship of A.A. by carrying the message through:
 - a) public media
 - b) electronic media
 - c) public information meetings
 - d) speaking to community groups"
- The committee discussed the 1996 reports on A.A. Web Site activity. The committee applauded the creation of the A.A. Web Site. The committee requested a cumulative monthly reporting of accesses beyond the A.A. Web Site Home Page.
- The committee reviewed the report on C.P.C., C.F., P.I. and T.F. Service Kits and Workbooks and, in order to create consistency in language, the committee agreed to define this material as "P.I. Service Kits and Workbooks."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Service Kit and Workbook and agreed to the following changes:
 - 1) Add a List of Contents to the Public Information Service Kit.
- At the next printing of the P.I. Workbook:
 - 1) Add an explanation regarding the 1996 Membership Survey to the section entitled "Background on Triennial A.A. Membership Survey." This explanation will be consistent with text in the 1996 Membership Survey pamphlet.
 - 2) Add a section entitled "Suggested Public Information Committee Goals" based on sharing from a district Public Information committee.
 - 3) Add the following explanation to the title page:

"The A.A. workbooks are compiled from the practical experience of A.A. members in the various service areas. They also reflect guidance given through the Twelve Traditions and the General Service Conference (U.S. & Canada)."

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee unanimously agreed that there was no need to footnote the "Introduction" to the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* because the A.A. World Services Board holds the copy-

When the printer delivered the blueprint of this *Report* to the Publications department the label on the envelope read: "Contents: Blueprint for text of *1997 Final Solution*."

rights in trust on behalf of the General Service Board, U.S. and Canada, and has the right of decision in such matters.

- The committee considered at length a suggestion to eliminate the last names of G.S.R.s and group contacts from the confidential A.A. directories, publishing only the first name and first initial of the last name of those members, and agreed that full names of general service representatives and group contacts may continue to be used in confidential A.A. directories. The committee requests that the General Service Office continue to exercise discretion by distributing A.A. confidential directories within the Fellowship only, and that each A.A. member respect the anonymity of members listed in the directories.
- The committee discussed the request that the General Service Office extend the delay in processing "Alcoholics Anonymous New Group Forms" from 30 days to 60 days and agreed that there was not sufficient need to extend the delay beyond 30 days.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- After reviewing the material collected by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities regarding changes in the treatment field, the committee thanked the trustees' Committee for its efforts and encouraged them to continue to monitor changes.
- The committee discussed the increasing need for direct contacts with alcoholics in the wide variety of treatment modalities and encourages area committees to assist districts in developing locally-sensitive methods of bridging the gap to Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee encourages the trustees' Committee to continue their efforts to share information with others involved in bridging the gap for alcoholics into our Fellowship.
- The committee discussed efforts in their home areas to address the need for helping newer A.A. members feel comfortable in carrying the message to alcoholics reaching our doors and suggested we encourage local sharing with regional correspondents at the General Service Office and the Fellowship through Box 4-5-9, the Grapevine and other vehicles.
- The committee discussed the 1996 reports on A.A. Web Site activity and agreed to forward the following suggestions to A.A. World Services, Inc. for consideration: that tracking methods continue to be developed and e-mail addresses be added to the screens.
- The committee reviewed the letter to treatment professionals and appreciates the fresh approach.

TRUSTEES

- After reviewing the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee suggested the following statement under Scope to reflect actual practice:

"The committee reviews resumes of appointed committee members recommended to serve on trustees' committees, i.e., Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Literature."

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

FINANCE

- It was recommended that the *General Service Board Policy* that states: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a

discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined." Be changed to:

"Whenever a discount is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, e.g., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined. Alcoholics Anonymous may not accept any money from outside sources to defray expenses."

- It was recommended that there be a reaffirmation of the 1981 Conference Advisory Action - "All future events, such as the International Convention, not be planned to operate on a deficit basis, and it was also recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting" as this is still a prudent policy.

LITERATURE

- It was recommended that the suggested changes to the *Living Sober* booklet be approved with some modifications. **(Tabled)**

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- It was recommended that the following language be added to the back cover and List of Contents of the Public Information Service Kit and to the back cover of the Public Information Workbook:

"This service material is approved by the Conference Public Information Committee."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- It was recommended that the Treatment Facilities Workbook and the Treatment Facilities Handbook be Conference-approved literature rather than service material.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

It was recommended that when fiscally prudent, A.A.W.S. Publishing ought to place as a high priority goal, the audio-taping in English, and the audio-taping in Spanish of current A.A. (book) printed literature. **(Failed)**

Floor Action #2:

It was recommended that the following changes to the *Living Sober* booklet be approved:

- Page 55, after the ninth full paragraph: (footnote) "A.A. World Services publishes a pamphlet titled *The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs*. Many members who must take medications for medical conditions have found its suggestions very helpful. The pamphlet is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature. It may also be helpful to give this pamphlet to our personal physicians to assist them in increasing their knowledge of the nature of our illness, alcoholism."

- Page 4, second paragraph: Remove the sentence: "We have also found that we have to stay away from mind-changing drugs." **(Failed)**

Floor Action #3:

It is recommended that last names of G.S.R.s and group contacts be eliminated from the confidential A.A. directories and that only the first name and first initial of the last name of those members be listed. **(Not Considered)**